

Diagram 1

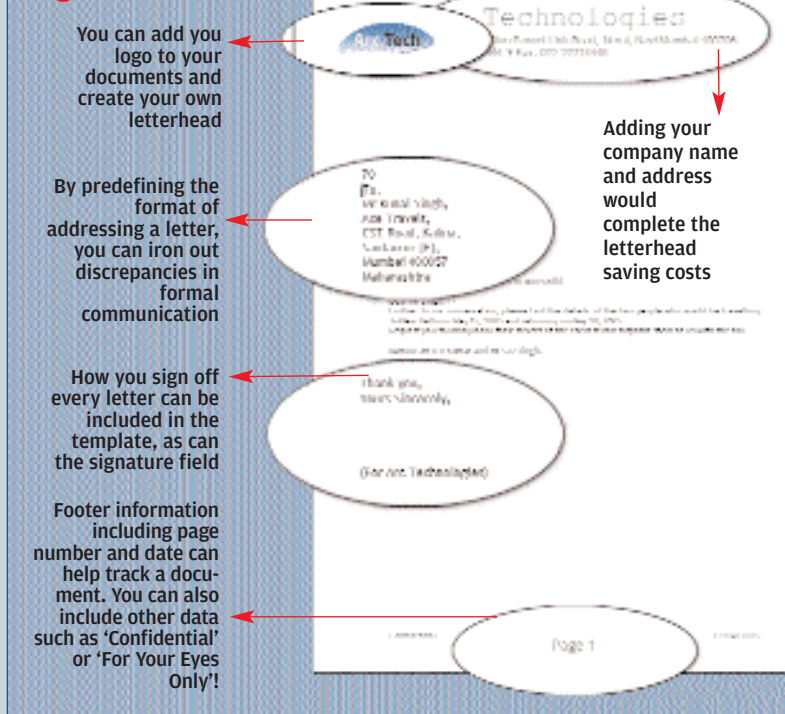


Diagram 2

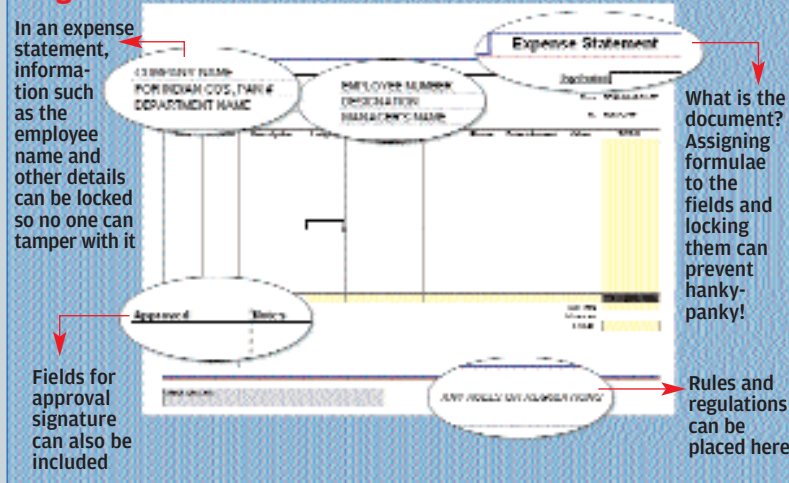
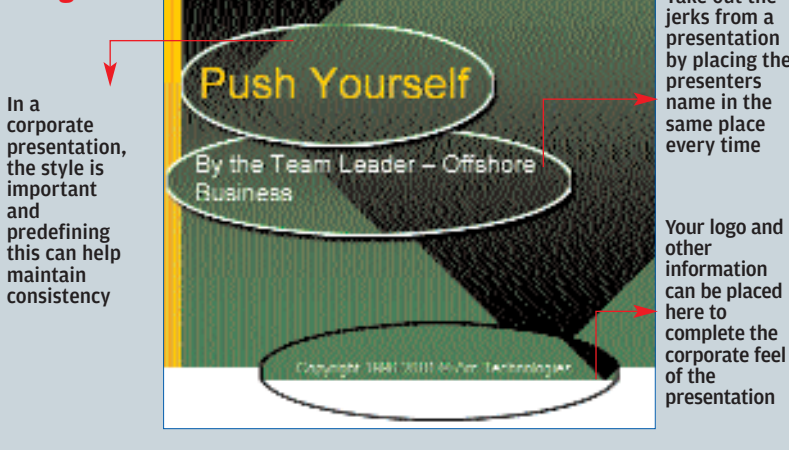


Diagram 3



MS PowerPoint

We all make presentations and have some fixed elements in every presentation, such as your company name or logo, and would like to maintain these elements for every presentation you make.

You could do this using the Auto Content Wizard, and PowerPoint will generate a complete presentation document. There are various types of presentations to choose from as well.

You could then choose the header or footer space to add your logo (and any other information you want), and save this as a master slide. This slide can then be used throughout the presentation. (Refer to Diagram 3 for more info)

Additionally, you could also change the style of the text that appears across a presentation by doing the following:

Make sure no objects are selected. From the 'Format' menu, select 'Font'. Make all the changes that you want and click 'OK'.

From that point on, new text will be created in the style you just defined.

To set the formatting for the title or slide body objects, go to the 'Slide Master' and format these objects on the master.

Why Templatise?

While some of this stuff sounds rather basic, the reason behind emphasising this is the cost saving it could bring you and the identity you could create.

Take for example the template created in MS Word. If you could have a logo and your address placed in every printout you take, you would not need to make letterheads for your company. All employees could print out their letters on ordinary paper.

By creating a universal template in MS PowerPoint, your presentations could have uniformity and consistency of style. Clients can come to expect this from you and it also displays a certain level of discipline.

More importantly, though, you could templatise spreadsheets for purposes such as claiming expenses—a company balance sheet with locked formulas can ensure that there is no misappropriation. All the employee has to do, is fill in the requisite fields and take a print. The advantages are obvious.

Programs such as Word and PowerPoint offer an even greater level of customisation that can help you take out the hassles of worrying about how every document is going out.

One thing you need to remember in all this, though, is to save your file as a template and not as a file. All the others need to do is open this template.

You also don't need to worry about anyone overwriting your template file because the program will automatically open the 'Save As' dialog box whenever someone hits [Ctrl] + [S].

It's a good idea to create a variety of templates for various requirements that could save everyone time and a lot of headache! ■

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